You may request that your urgent care claim on appeal be reviewed simultaneously by us and OPM. Please let us know that you would like a simultaneous review of your urgent care claim by OPM either in writing at the time you appeal our initial decision, or by calling us at 800-821-6136. You may also call OPM's Postal Service Insurance Operations (PSIO) at 202-936-0002 to ask for the simultaneous review. We will cooperate with OPM so they can quickly review your claim on appeal. In addition, if you did not indicate that your claim was a claim for urgent care, then call us at 800-821-6136. If it is determined that your claim is an urgent care claim, we will expedite our review (if we have not yet responded to your claim).

- **Concurrent care claims**

A concurrent care claim involves care provided over a period of time or over a number of treatments. We will treat any reduction or termination of our pre-approved course of treatment before the end of the approved period of time or number of treatments as an appealable decision. This does not include reduction or termination due to benefit changes or if your enrollment ends. If we believe a reduction or termination is warranted, we will allow you sufficient time to appeal and obtain a decision from us before the reduction or termination takes effect.

A reduction or termination of care can occur due to lack of medical necessity or the member's failure to demonstrate measurable progress towards the established treatment goals and further medical professional intervention is not expected to result in a significant improvement of the patient's condition.

If you request an extension of an ongoing course of treatment at least 24 hours prior to the expiration of the approved time period and this is also an urgent care claim, we will make a decision within 24 hours after we receive the claim.

- **Emergency inpatient admission**

If you have an emergency admission due to a condition that you reasonably believe puts your life in danger or could cause serious damage to bodily function, you, your representative, the physician, or the facility must notify us within two business days following the day of the emergency admission, even if you have been discharged from the facility.

- **Maternity care**

You do not need precertification of a maternity admission for a routine delivery. However, if your medical condition requires you to stay more than 48 hours after a vaginal delivery or 96 hours after a cesarean section, then your physician or the facility must contact us for precertification of additional days. Further, if your baby stays after you are discharged, your physician or the facility must contact us for precertification of additional days for your baby.

Note: When a newborn requires definitive treatment during or after the mother's stay, the newborn is considered a patient in their own right. If the newborn is eligible for coverage, regular medical or surgical benefits apply rather than maternity benefits.

- **If your hospital stay needs to be extended**

If your facility stay - including for maternity care - needs to be extended, you, your representative, your doctor or the facility must ask us to approve the additional days. If you remain in the facility beyond the number of days we approved and did not get the additional days precertified, then:

- for the part of the admission that was medically necessary, we will pay inpatient benefits, but,
- for the part of the admission that was not medically necessary, we will pay only medical services and supplies otherwise payable on an outpatient basis and will not pay inpatient benefits.